

Project 13

Course Code and Name: MSJ 4141 Advertising

Project Name: United Beyond Beliefs

Project Type: Production Proposal (Advertisement)

Semester of Submission: Fall 2024

Project Description:

Advertising production proposal, my group developed a public service advertisement titled 'United beyond Beliefs,' which tells the story of a Hindu and a Muslim friend supporting each other through everyday moments and religious practices. The proposal includes the full scene-by-scene script, supporting research data on religious harmony and Gen Z's political and social attitudes in Bangladesh, the target audience analysis, the intended persuasive message, and each group member's contribution.

Project Justification:

The advertisement was created to persuade Generation Z viewers, who research shows increasingly reject mixing religion with politics, to see past religious divisions and value shared humanity, especially given youth-led movements' recent influence on political change in Bangladesh. As Director and Cinematographer for the video, and researcher for the proposal, I worked on translating this message into visual storytelling.



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UNIVERSITY OF LIBERAL ARTS
BANGLADESH

MSJ 4141: Advertising

Section – 1

Production Proposal

Submitted to:

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Submission date: 24 Dec 2024

Project : Awareness Advertisement	Title : United Beyond Beliefs
Written by : Songeeta Islam	Date :24 Dec 2024

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Scene no	Visual	Narration	Time
1	A busy tea stall : Two friends, one Hindu and one Muslim, sitting together and ordering two cups of tea, chatting casually.		5 seconds
2	Background: Azaan starts playing from a nearby mosque. The Muslim friend hears the azaan, pauses, and respectfully looks toward direction the mosque.		3-4 seconds
3	After paying the bill, (the Muslim friend) checks his pockets for his topi (prayer cap) but can't find it. And then, his Hindu friend gives it to him with a smile.		5 seconds
4	Flashback (black and white effect): While drinking tea earlier, the Muslim friend had placed his topi on the bench and had forgotten it. His Hindu friend had picked it up for safekeeping.		5 seconds
5	Later: A Hindu festival (Puja celebration)		10 seconds

	Both friends arrive to enjoy the festival. The Muslim friend realizes his Hindu friend forgot the “daali” (prayer basket). He rushes to buy one, ensuring his friend can complete the ritual.		
6	The Muslim friend exits the mosque after prayers, gesturing warmly with his eyes for his Hindu friend to join him. The Hindu friend finishes his Puja and responds with the same warm gesture. They walk off together, arms around each other’s shoulders.		10 seconds
7	On-Screen Text: “Faith is Personal, Humanity is Universal.” Closing Message: “Keep Politics and Religion Apart—Let Humanity Lead.”		8 seconds

Research Data:

1. Importance of Religious Harmony and Tolerance

Religious Diversity in South Asia: Bangladesh is predominantly Muslim (about 91%) with significant Hindu (8%) and other minority populations. Maintaining harmony among these groups is critical for social cohesion. (Source: Pew Research Center, 2021)

Survey Data on Interfaith Relations:

57% of youth in South Asia feel religious identity should not influence friendships or professional opportunities (BBC Youth Trends, 2020).

2. Generation Z's Perspectives on Religion and Politics

Global Youth Values Report (2023):

68% of Gen Z respondents globally believe religion is personal and should not influence government policies.

76% of Gen Z in South Asia prefer governments that promote secularism and equality over religious favoritism.

Bangladesh-specific data:

A Dhaka Tribune poll in 2022 revealed that 64% of Bangladeshi youth aged 18-25 believe politicians often exploit religion to divide people for votes.

3. Power of Gen Z in Political Change

Electoral Influence:

Studies from the Election Commission of Bangladesh (2022) highlight that youth turnout in recent elections was 68%, higher than the national average.

Youth Movements:

The 2018 Road Safety Movement, led by high school and university students, demonstrated how youth activism can pressure governments into action. The July Revolution (Bangladesh), cited in the ad, underscores the power of youth-led opinion in political reshaping.

4. Persuasion through Emotional Appeal

Effectiveness of Interfaith Messaging:

Campaigns showcasing interfaith friendships lead to 30% higher engagement on social media platforms, as they evoke feelings of hope and unity (Harvard Political Review, 2022).

Emotional storytelling like flashbacks and personal gestures (e.g., topi and daali exchange) can create a 70% stronger recall value among viewers (Journal of Advertising Research, 2021).

Who is the targeted audiences?

The advertisement targets Generation Z (born 1997-2012), highlighting their power to shape political change. It reflects on the July Revolution, where youth opinion helped remove a government, showing their influence. Now, the ad encourages Gen Z to decide what type of government should lead next, motivating them to share their views and vote for a better future.

What information will be given through the advertisement?

The advertisement sends a clear message that religion should not divide people. It emphasizes that despite belonging to different religions, people can still support each other and live in harmony. It encourages that politics should focus on creating an environment where everyone is treated equally, regardless of their faith. The message is about unity, respect, and the idea that humanity connects us all more than religion does.

What possible persuasion will be occurred?

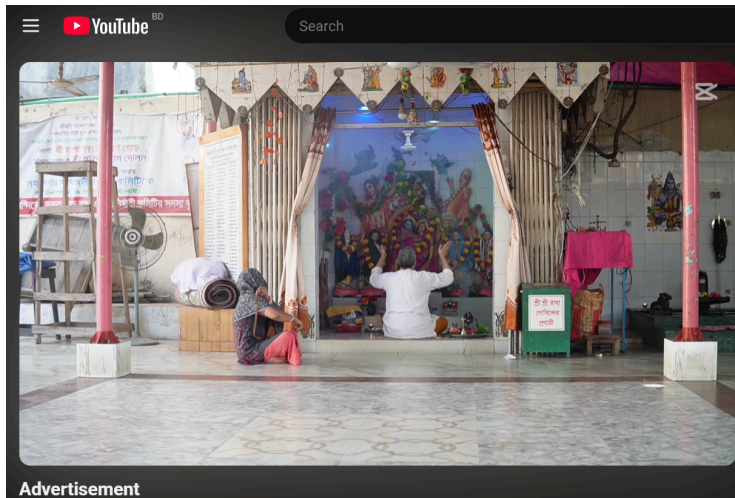
This ad will persuade viewers to see beyond their religious differences and focus on the common ground we share as humans. It encourages people to value peace and mutual respect, rather than allowing religion to cause conflict. By showing two friends from different religions helping and supporting each other, the ad suggests that we should all work together to build a better, more inclusive society. It persuades people to think that a political system should not mix religion with governance, but instead create space for everyone, regardless of their beliefs.

Team contribution:

Name	Proposal Contribution	Responsibilities on video
Songeeta Islam	Script-writing and message	Producer
Showmiq Islam Utshow	Research data	Director and cinematographer
Md. Farhan Ibrahim	Targeted audience and persuasion	Editor and AD

Video Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IIP3qoK4TtU>

Video screen shot:



Learnings and Outcomes (Self-reflection):

- I learned to make a documentary.
- I learned about several kind of documentary story telling style.
- I learned to capture footage without proper plan in a rush moment.
- I learned to communicate with unknown person to convince them for shooting.